and natural gas, and will serve as a transit state for energy from Iraq to the Mediterranean Sea.

As for the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, following decades in which the Israeli government insisted on bilateral negotiations (with each of the Arab parties separately), the time has come to try a strategy of multilateral talks (this was discussed extensively in the previous section). The United States has a key role to play in leading the process, and the moderate Arab states —Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Jordan, and the Gulf States—will contribute by persuading the parties to narrow the gaps between them on the road to the final agreement. The Palestinians will have to find a satisfactory solution to Gaza, regarding which the Arab countries involved in the process will also have a significant influence. The resolution of the Gaza issue will be based on an economic solution in the form of a "Marshall Plan" of one kind or another, funded by the rich Arab world, the United States, and international bodies. The containment of Hamas as a terrorist organization will be possible against the backdrop of the new Middle East, which will banish the phenomenon of radical Islamic terrorism.

The foundation of a bold new architecture in the Middle East, following a century of Sykes-Picot, should have the backing of an agreed-upon international body either within or outside of the United Nations, whose sole role will be to turn this vision into a reality.

To anyone reading this chapter whose immediate reaction is a lack of faith, I suggest taking a pause before coming back and reading it again.

UNRWA: "J'Accuse!"

The title of this section is borrowed, of course, from Emile Zola's open letter about the Dreyfus case. I chose this title because I think it inspires curiosity in the reader, who may ask him- or herself, "Who is he accusing and of what?"

Well, the deeper I delve into the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, the more I become convinced that all of us, and especially the Israeli governments throughout the years, bear the main burden for the Palestinian refugee problem and its swelling from about 700,000 refugees in 1949 to about 5 million in 2015. We are to blame for the birth of the "right of return" ethos,